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Off the Record

What your feed won't tell you

ISSUE NO. 4 · WEEK OF NOV 16, 2026

BREAKING ANALYSIS

8th Largest Economy in the World Sees Regime Change for the First Time in Decades

How Texas's changing guard will completely change its economy.

Democrat **Gina Hinojosa unseated Greg Abbott**, ending three decades of Republican governors, and **James Talarico beat Ken Paxton** with about **55%** for the state's first Democratic Senate win since **1988**. *Texas goes from a billionaire technocratic candy land (Elon's factory town, beach buying) and oil barons to a state betting on renewables, and 40 years of educational failure finally get fixed by a teacher-turned-senator.*

Foreign Affairs

★ EDITOR'S PICK OPINION

STFU Liberal… Wait, We Lost Texas, Kansas and South Carolina???

Democrats won the midterms. Now the real fight is inside the party.

Democrats **flipped seven Senate seats** (Kansas, Iowa, Texas, Ohio, Maine, North Carolina and South Carolina) for a **54–44 majority**, and picked up **28 House seats**. Mississippi is still too close to call, with Democrat Scott Colom ahead by just **43 votes**. *Now internal politics decide whether the same liberal machine keeps the wheel or a new crop of candidates takes over the leadership. Either way, Democrats control who gets confirmed to the federal bench for a whiiile.*

Domestic

OPINION

ENSO ENSO ENSO: I Told You So

El Niño is already making our weather go haywire. Prepare for freezing rain.

Montreal hit **23°C on Nov 4**, smashing the **1956 record of 18.3°C**. The WMO says this El Niño could be **one of the strongest since 1950** and will last into **February 2027**, and Intact Insurance warns of **more freezing rain and ice** this winter. *Anyone who knows me knows I've been talking about this for over a year. The Ice Storm of '98 is gonna look like fkn peanuts. Prepare ;)*

Markets

OPINION

Your 401(k)s Are Citadel's Exit Liquidity

Who's left holding the bag before the bust? Check your retirement account.

SpaceX's **$75B listing** in June was the **largest IPO ever**, and Anthropic just filed for one that could raise **up to $100B**. **58% of US adults** own stock, mostly through retirement accounts, and **97% of 401(k)s** hold equities. *Every mega-IPO gets funnelled straight into index funds and target-date plans at peak prices. When the bust comes, the billionaires are already out and your retirement is the bag.*

Last Week's Call

- **Talarico takes the dub**
  He beat Paxton with **about 55%**, the **first Democratic Senate win in Texas since 1988**. *I've been calling this for 2 months.*
- **Kushner's phone hacked**
  Called it in Issue 1's cybersecurity piece. Journalist Matthew Cole alleges **Dutch intelligence had access to Jared Kushner's iPhone for years**. Kushner denies it. *Nobody's phone is safe.*
- **S&P 500 crash**
  The S&P 500 erased **$2.2 trillion in about 40 minutes** on Nov 5, its **worst day since April 2025**. *Still not the big one.*